



As the momentum shifted in the pivotal second set, shades of the old hyper-emotional Sabalenka returned to haunt her. While Sabalenka fumed and went from the sublime to the ridiculous, Gauff counter-punched cleverly to elicit 70 errors from her frustrated foe.

Gauff jumped for joy after her 6-7(5), 6-2, 6-4 victory for her first French Open and second Major title.

But that euphoria proved short-lived, at least for the rest of 2025. Gauff cooled off fast, losing in the Wimbledon first round, the U.S. Open fourth round and the WTA Finals round-robin stage.

Sabalenka was slightly favoured to win her first Wimbledon, even though she had missed the tournament the previous year.

Swiatek, whose No. 8 seeding reflected her 12-month decline, took advantage of the upset losses of Gauff, No. 3 seed Pegula, 2022 Wimbledon champion Rybakina and No. 7 Mirra Andrejeva to streak all the way to the final in the bottom half of the draw.

After failing to qualify at

Wimbledon a year ago, Amanda Anisimova had racked up a 5-1 record against top-10 players this season. Though she was a decided underdog against Sabalenka in the semifinals, the 23-year-old American boasted a 5-3 edge in their rivalry.

After losing three-set heartbreakers to Keys in the Australian Open final and Gauff in the French Open final, the pressure was on Sabalenka at Wimbledon. In the fluctuating, 18-point game while serving at 4-5, the Belarusian blinked first and double-faulted to lose the opening set 6-4.

Sabalenka, who hadn't lost a match in straight sets at a Major since the 2020 U.S. Open, fought back. Screaming as she threw her wiry, strong 5'11 body into every shot, she won the second set 6-4.

With Sabalenka serving at 4-5 in the deciding set, both had won 104 points. Anisimova earned three match points, leading love-40. Sabalenka staved off the first two, but Anisimova belted a bold cross-court forehand winner to clinch the 6-4, 4-6, 6-4 triumph.

Hit-and-miss: Coco Gauff defeated Sabalenka in the final for her first French Open title, but failed to impress in the next two Grand Slams.

Swiatek's flawless 6-0, 6-0 demolition of Anisimova in the forgettable, 57-minute final was yet another stunner in the 'expect the unexpected' world of women's tennis.

But revenge and redemption for Anisimova would come soon during her home Slam in Flushing Meadows.

Anisimova turned the tables, making auspicious history herself: she became the first double-bagel victim to reach the final of the next Grand Slam event.

Amanda imposed her powerful groundstrokes on Swiatek, attacked the Pole's second serve, and kept the speedy superstar on the run throughout the impressive 6-4, 6-3 quarterfinal upset.

For her part, Sabalenka overcame No. 4 and defending finalist Pegula 4-6, 6-3, 6-4 in the semis.

Before entering Arthur Ashe Stadium for the championship match, an upbeat Sabalenka told interviewer Mary Joe Fernandez, "It's a dream. I'm living a dream life." In the predictable battle of first-strike tennis, the Belarusian brought more versatility, poise, precision and consistency to prevail 6-3, 7-6(3).

Despite Sabalenka's failures in critical three-set defeats this season, she remains a terror in tie-breakers, winning a record 19 in a row. This time, Sabalenka raced to a 6-1 lead and hit an unreturnable serve on championship point. Then she went down on her knees, covered her face, and shed a few tears.

Afterwards, she recalled a vow she made during a July vacation in Greece. She would ban bad thoughts that undermined her during crushing losses in two Major finals and in the Wimbledon semifinals.

"I thought that everything was going to go easily my way, which was completely the wrong mindset... To bring the fight and be able to handle my emotions the way I did in this final, it means a lot," Sabalenka said. "I'm super proud of myself right now."